Figure 4.5 `WelcomePageMiddleware` handles a request. The request passes from the reverse proxy to the ASP.NET Core web server and finally to the middleware pipeline, which generates an HTML response.

The request passes to the ASP.NET Core web server, which builds a representation of the request and passes it to the middleware pipeline. As it's the first (only!) middleware in the pipeline, `WelcomePageMiddleware` receives the request and must decide how to handle it. The middleware responds by generating an HTML response, no matter what request it receives. This response passes back to the ASP.NET Core web server, which forwards it to the reverse proxy and then to the user to display in their browser.

As with all ASP.NET Core applications, you define the middleware pipeline in Program.cs by calling `Use*` methods on the `WebApplication` instance. To create your first middleware pipeline, which consists of a single middleware component, you need a single method call. The application doesn't need any extra configuration or services, so your whole application consists of the four lines in the following listing.

Listing 4.1 Program.cs for a Welcome-page middleware pipeline

```
WebApplicationBuilder builder = WebApplication.CreateBuilder(args);  ❶
WebApplication app = builder.Build();                                ❶

app.UseWelcomePage();                                                ❷

app.Run();                                                           ❸
```

❶ Uses the default WebApplication configuration

❷ The only custom middleware in the pipeline

❸ Runs the application to handle requests